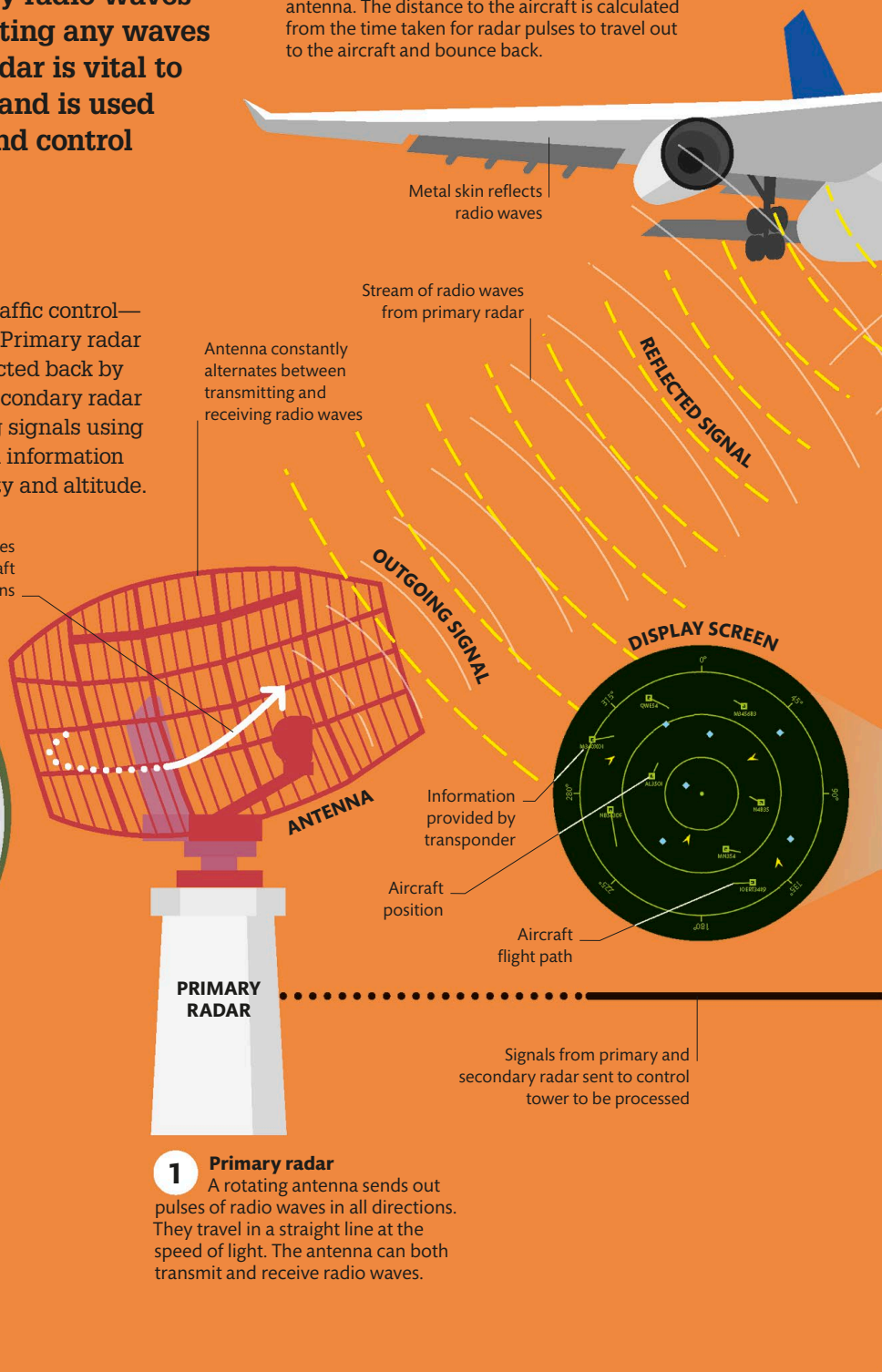
Radar

Radar is used to locate distant objects by sending out high-frequency radio waves (see pp.180–181) and detecting any waves that are reflected back. Radar is vital to air traffic control systems and is used to track aircraft in flight and control their movements safely.

Air traffic control radar

Two types of radar are used in air traffic control—primary radar and secondary radar. Primary radar transmits radio waves that are reflected back by an aircraft, revealing its position. Secondary radar relies on an aircraft actively sending signals using a device called a transponder to add information about the aircraft, such as its identity and altitude.



WHAT OTHER TECHNOLOGIES USE RADAR?

Radar has several other uses, including in ocean and geological surveys, mapping, astronomy, and in intruder alarms and cameras.

RADAR WAS USED TO MAP THE SURFACES OF THE PLANETS MERCURY AND VENUS